

The Non-Coder's Guide to AI: How to Prompt Like a Pro

A Practical Blueprint to Turn Plain English into High-Quality Work & Web Software

By **Ishmael Harry-Deckor** • Founder, Sena Academy • *"Stop learning to code. Start learning to build."*

1. Why 90% of People Get Bad Results from AI

Most people open AI tools like ChatGPT, Claude, or Google AI Studio and type something generic:

- ✗ "Write me a business plan for my project."
- ✗ "Build me a website for my business."

And what does the AI give them? A long, boring, generic response filled with corporate buzzwords that is completely useless in the real world.

The secret to mastering AI in 2026 isn't learning to write complex computer code—it's **learning how to think and prompt with clarity**.

2. Framework 1: The C.G.C. Formula

Every high-performing prompt must have three distinct layers:

[CONTEXT] → Who is the AI, and what is the exact situation?

[GOAL] → What is the exact, specific output you want?

[CONSTRAINTS] → What rules **MUST** the AI follow (tone, length, what to avoid)?

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE PROMPT

"[Context]: You are an experienced digital business consultant in Ghana helping a local car rental company in Accra.

[Goal]: Write a 3-part WhatsApp message sequence to follow up with clients who inquired about renting a car for a weekend event but haven't paid their deposit yet.

[Constraints]: Keep each message under 50 words. The tone must be polite, warm, and professional. Mention Mobile Money payment options. Avoid corporate American jargon."

3. Framework 2: The "Reverse Interview" Method

When you have a project in mind but don't know all the technical details, **never try to write a long prompt from scratch**. Instead, make the AI interview you.

COPY-PASTE PROMPT

"I want to create a **[INSERT YOUR PROJECT: e.g. digital registration portal for an event / client booking system for a hair salon in Kumasi]** .

Before you give me any answers or write anything, I want you to act as an expert project consultant and ask me 5 clarifying questions one by one to understand my target audience, budget, timeline, and goals.

Wait for my answer after each question before asking the next."

Why this works: It forces the AI to extract your exact business needs step-by-step, resulting in a 100% custom solution instead of a generic guess.

4. Framework 3: The "Idea-to-App Blueprint" (Using Google AI Studio)

You don't need any coding software to turn a business idea into a visual prototype. You can do it completely free inside **Google AI Studio** (aistudio.google.com).

- **100% Free:** Sign in directly with your regular Google/Gmail account at aistudio.google.com.
- **Zero Software to Install:** Runs directly inside your mobile or laptop browser.
- **Instant Visual Mockups:** It lets you see what your app will look like right on screen.

UNIVERSAL IDEA-TO-APP PROMPT (WITH PLACEHOLDERS)

"I have a business idea: I want to build a simple web application for **[INSERT BUSINESS TYPE – e.g. a car rental in Accra / a bakery in Kumasi / a church event / a hair salon]** .

The main problem it solves is: **[INSERT PROBLEM – e.g. customers currently have to call or DM manually on WhatsApp to book and pay]** .

Act as an expert software architect in Google AI Studio and break this down into 3 clear sections:

1. The Customer Journey: Exactly what the customer sees, clicks, and experiences from the homepage to confirmation.
2. The Required Form Fields: The exact information we need to collect (e.g. **[INSERT REQUIRED DETAILS – e.g. Full Name, WhatsApp Number, Service Type, Date/Time, Mobile Money Option]**).
3. The Visual Layout & Live Mockup: Generate the clean, modern visual layout code so I can see what this application looks like right inside my browser.

Keep the design clean, lightweight, and 100% mobile-friendly for Ghanaian users."

5. Framework 4: The 4 Golden Rules of Prompting

1. **Rule 1: Give AI a Role:** Always start by assigning an identity (*"Act as a senior event coordinator..."* or *"Act as a copywriter..."*).
2. **Rule 2: Provide Examples:** Paste an example of what you like before asking for the result.
3. **Rule 3: Use Step-by-Step Thinking:** Add this phrase at the end of hard tasks: *"Think step-by-step before giving your final answer."*
4. **Rule 4: Never Restart—Iterate:** If the AI's answer is 70% good, reply: *"Make the tone more casual, cut paragraph two in half, and make the button green."*

6. The Next Step: Building Real Software with AI

Prompting AI to plan ideas is step 1. The real breakthrough happens when you use these exact same plain English prompts to **build and deploy real, working web applications** that Ghanaian businesses will pay you **GHS 1,500 – GHS 5,000** for.

In our **free live online workshop in September**, we will open our laptops and show you how to use these prompt frameworks to build a complete, live web app from scratch!

 **Join Our WhatsApp Community for Free Workshop Access**

Get the exact September date, live online access link, and free templates:

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